

CDN Incident Alert: 0065. TLP: CLEAR			Date
Title	PL	Undermining the credibility of polling stations	13/05/2025

Summary

- In March, Facebook and TikTok users shared videos showing how to remove votes from ballots using a lighter. The creators of the message encourage people to take their own pen to the polls or suggest that the elections are pointless due to fraud.
- The video was distributed in social media before the Polish presidential elections in May, but its real context indicated that the recording came from Kazakhstan in 2019.
- The most popular copies of the recording received up to 20 thousand shares on Facebook. The recording could undermine the integrity of the election and affect voter turnout.
- The campaign used distort facts and reuse existing content.
- Recommendations include stepping up pro-turnout activities and strengthening the credibility of electoral commissions

Incident

A video was published on [Facebook](#) and TikTok (1, 2, 3) showing the situation at the polling station. A man signs a ballot with a pen placed in the voting booth, then puts a lighter flame on it - this makes the ink disappear. He then shows this action to people sitting in the electoral commission. Recipients of the message believe this is evidence of electoral manipulation and vote suppression in Poland.

Narrative

Meta-narrative: Poland presented as a country with risk of electoral fraud

Sub-narratives: Elections in Poland are not conducted in accordance with European standards.

Impact

Media coverage: according to the Demagog Association, information on this topic was shared at least over 40,000 times on social media – include Facebook and TikTok.

Real consequences: After the information was published, many people began to doubt the point of voting or the credibility of the electoral commissions. Some declared that they would not go to the polls, that the result was a foregone conclusion, or that they would take their own voting pen just in case.

Key Objectives and Behaviours (DISARM Red Framework)

N/A

Recommendations and Actions Taken

Action taken: Flagged in the Code of Practice Against Disinformation Rapid Response System.

Recommendations: N/A.

Repo rt	Topic	Evidence	Authors	Platforms	Logo
N/A	Polish Election	In text	Adam Majchrzak, Pawel Terpilowski - Demagog	Facebook, TikTok	